there is Kreeda Bharati; in medicine there is National Medicos Organisation; and the Aarogya Bharati that promotes Indian systems of healing. Saksham works for the rights of the differently abled and is a respected name in the field of disability services.'[107]

For RSS ideologues, the Sangh is 'a network of networks'. As Ambekar put it, 'There is no limit on the number of organisations that can be seeded to support the multiple issues that necessitate intervention. Thus, a large number of front organisations can be created with Sangh inspiration … Parivar organisations are referred to as Sangh Srishti, or creation, but the fact is that these are India's creations born out of Indian visions. The Sangh's mantra is the synergy of constructive energies in national interest.'[108]

Exactly how many organisations are affiliated to the Sangh remains unclear, but these groups span a 'broad spectrum of interests, including politics, agriculture, public health, education, veterans' affairs, religion, entrepreneurship and tribal welfare. Moreover, new groups continue to form to address fresh challenges, including a new affiliate that focuses on strengthening family bonds (the Kutumb Prabodhan) and another for female empowerment (the Stree Shakti).'[109] There are many that are not counted as full affiliates till they show they can be autonomous. The Kutumb Prabodhan, for example, started outreach work in 2010 and Stree Shakti in the 1990s, but they only became full affiliates in 2017.[110]

RSS leaders insist that these affiliate organisations are not remote-controlled, that they work as autonomous 'domain experts'. The ground for creating what the RSS calls the 'Sangh Vividh Kshetra Sanghathan' [the Sangh's structure of organisations working in various fields] was prepared during the first sarsanghchalak Dr Hegdewar's lifetime. However, most Sangh-linked bodies are independent and autonomous.'[111] They 'are called Parivar because they share the same genealogy of ideas. But they are all autonomous and independent in structures and functions. A large number of activists, or karyakartas, in these organisations are not swayamsevaks. However, there are swayamsevaks among them, who move from the RSS to work in Parivar organisations, while some new karyakartas over time become swayamsevaks. If any